

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

Understanding Us

A Journal for Seeing Your Relationship Clearly



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · for couples & partners

WELCOME

Before You Begin



Every relationship is two people, two histories, and two sets of unspoken expectations trying to share one life.

No wonder it gets tangled sometimes.

This journal helps you untangle — with curiosity instead of blame.

You can write it solo to understand your relationship better, or use the questions as conversation starters with your partner. Either way, the rule is the same: honesty over comfort, understanding over winning.

This is about seeing clearly. What you do with the clarity is always up to you.

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The image shows a worksheet with a light gray background and a decorative border of small dots. At the top center, the words "STARTING POINT" are written in a bold, black, sans-serif font. Below this, the title "Where We Are" is displayed in a large, bold, black serif font. Underneath the title is a small red heart icon. A paragraph of italicized text follows, reading: "Describe your relationship right now like you're explaining it to a wise friend who won't judge either of you — the good, the strained, and the confusing." The lower half of the page contains fifteen horizontal lines for writing. At the bottom center, the website address "ilikeitdeep.us" is printed in a small, black, sans-serif font.

STARTING POINT

Where We Are

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PART ONE

How We Got Here



*Every 'us' has an origin story and a set of
habits it picked up along the way.*

What drew you to them in the beginning — and which of those things are still true?



What has your relationship survived so far? Give yourselves credit for the list.



What patterns from each of your childhoods show up in how you two love and fight?



*When are you two at your absolute best together?
Describe a specific time.*



What's changed between you — for better and for worse — since the early days?



What does love look like in your daily life now, in small ordinary moments?



PART TWO

Where We Get Stuck



Most couples don't have fifty problems. They have three on a loop. Find yours.

What's the argument you two keep having in different costumes? What's it really about underneath?



*What do you need that you haven't clearly asked for
— hoping they'd just know?*



What might THEY need that they haven't said? Take your best guess with generous eyes.



How do you each act when hurt — chase, shut down, snap, disappear? How do those styles collide?



What are you not saying to keep the peace, and what is that silence costing?



What's your part in the pattern? Just yours — brave and honest.



PART THREE

Building Us Forward



*Understanding is the doorway. Small changed
behavior is the house.*

*What would 'us at our best, most of the time'
actually look like day to day?*



What's one thing they do that you could appreciate out loud more often?



What repair looks good to you after a fight — and have you told them?



What's one small experiment you could try for a week — a check-in, a phone-free dinner, a kinder opening line?



*What do you want to protect about this relationship
no matter how busy life gets?*



*Write a few honest sentences to your partner —
whether or not you share them.*



Rules for the Next Disagreement



*Agreements to keep the fight about the problem, not each other.
Check the ones you'll adopt.*

- ☐ One issue per argument — no kitchen-sinking old wounds
- ☐ No 'always' and no 'never'
- ☐ Pause button allowed: 20 minutes to cool down, then come back
- ☐ Lower voices win — volume isn't evidence
- ☐ Say 'I feel' before 'you did'
- ☐ No threats to leave used as a weapon
- ☐ Ask 'what do you need right now?' at least once
- ☐ Repair before bed, even if the topic isn't solved
- ☐ No scorekeeping from before this conversation
- ☐ Remember: it's us versus the problem

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

Evidence of Us



The inside jokes, the hard days you got through together, the small kindnesses — collect them here. Read this page during the rough patches.

























BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



Understanding a relationship doesn't mean excusing everything in it. It means seeing it clearly enough to make real choices about it.

Whatever you found in these pages — tenderness, grief, hope, work to do — you're braver for looking.

If you two are stuck in a loop you can't exit alone, a couples counselor isn't a last resort. It's a shortcut. The strongest couples get help early, not last.



*Us versus the problem. Never us versus
each other.*



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